

Crime Scene Administration and Management

Collection and Preservation of Evidence



Learning Objectives

The student will be able to...

- Explain the steps for crime scene preparation
- Describe the basic six team positions of a crime scene unit
- Identify the twelve stages involved in a crime scene search
- List basic equipment required to process a crime scene
- Describe basic safety considerations
- Describe methods of controlling crime scene contamination

Advanced Preparation

Evidence teams need to be equipped with the necessary vehicles . . .



and other resources to assist with crime scene searches

Advanced Preparation

- Accumulate packaging and collection of materials necessary for typical crime scenes
- Accumulate PPE for personnel
- Monitor crime scene vehicle to be sure that it is properly packed at all times
- Liaison with specialists



Advanced Preparation

- | | |
|--|--|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Clothing• Communication• Lighting assistance• Shelter• PPE | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Food and liquids• Medical assistance• Scene security• Equipment• Specialty Tools |
|--|--|

Crime Scene Search Personnel

- Team Leader
- Photographer
- Sketch Preparer
- Evidence Custodian
- Evidence Recovery Personnel
- Specialists



Team Leader

- In charge of crime scene (is NOT in charge of investigation)
- Ensures safety of personnel
- Prepares administrative log
- Prepares narrative description
- Makes team assignments
- Conducts preliminary survey with photographer
- Monitors search process
- Responsible for scene security
- Conducts final survey
- Releases scene

Team Leader

ADMINISTRATIVE WORKSHEET		PAGE _____ OF _____
LOCATION CASE NUMBER PREPARED BY TIME AND DATE OF ARRIVAL PERSONNEL PRESENT AT SCENE AT TIME OF ARRIVAL	PERSONNEL INVOLVED IN SEARCH AND THEIR RESPECTIVE DUTIES	Who?
PERSON IN CHARGE OF SCENE AT TIME OF ARRIVAL CONTROL OF SCENE OBTAINED FROM TIME AND DATE OF CONTROL ACQUISITION CONDITION OF SCENE ON ARRIVAL (SEE RECOMMENDATIONS) LIGHTING CONDITIONS WEATHER CONDITIONS SCENE CONSISTS OF (GENERAL DESCRIPTION)	PRELIMINARY SURVEY/EVIDENCE EVALUATION (NOTES/OBSERVATIONS)	What?
Why?	SPECIAL SITUATIONS OR CONDITIONS (NOTES/OBSERVATIONS)	How?

Team Leader

ADMINISTRATIVE WORKSHEET continued		PAGE _____ OF _____
CRIME SCENE CONFERENCE (NOTES/OBSERVATIONS)	CRIME SCENE INVESTIGATION COMPLETED AND RELEASE OF SCENE AUTHORIZED NAME TITLE DATE TIME SIGNATURE NAME TITLE DATE TIME	Final survey and release of scene
FINAL SURVEY (NOTES/OBSERVATIONS)	ADDITIONAL NOTES/OBSERVATIONS	
ADMINISTRATIVE LOG: TIME EVENT/DESCRIPTION / INFORMATION Critical events		

Photographer

- Takes entry and exit photographs (with identifiers)
- Photographs entire scene: general, overall, medium and close-up (with and without a scale)
- Photographs evidence, latent fingerprints, and impressions
- Prepares photography log for a record



Photographer

PHOTOGRAPHER Who?	
DATE When?	ROLL #
LOCATION Where?	
CASE FILE	
AGENCY	

0 1 2 3 4 5 6

Photographer

CAMERA	LENS - Normal - N	LIGHT - Available - A
FILM : ASA	Wide - W	Elec.Strobe - E
ROLL No.	Macro - M	Flashbulb - F
	Tele. - T	

Photo No.	Light	ISO	f-stop	Description	Photo Log Sketch
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					
7					
8					
9					
10					
11					
12					
13					
14					
15					
16					
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35					
36					

REMARKS

Sketch Preparer

- Makes the sketch/diagram
- Designates and labels areas
- Documents where items of evidence were found on the sketch
- Takes appropriate measurements
- Places administrative information on the sketch
 - Case number, date, location, preparer
 - Indicate North
 - Not to Scale
 - Key or legend

Sketch Preparer

When? Where? Who? What?

This sketch is not to scale



Sketch Preparer

ROUGH SKETCH

Indicate North

Key or Legend

Case number, date, location, preparer

Note to scale

LEGEND:

- 1. TV SET
- 2. BED
- 3. NIGHT TABLE
- 4. OSMANIANE TABLE
- 5. OVEN - DISH WASH CUPB
- 6. BATH TUB
- 7. CHINA CABINET
- 8. BENCH

REFERENCE:

- SCALE IN FEET/INCHES
- COMPASS ORIENTATION
- EVIDENCE
- FIXED OBJECTS
- MEASUREMENTS
- KEY/LEGEND

Case number, date, location, preparer

Note to scale

Diagram/Sketch

Page _____ **Of** _____

LOCATION _____ DATE _____ CASE NUMBER _____ PREPARED BY/ASSISTANTS _____ _____ _____	DIAGRAM/SKETCH REFERENCE _____ REFERENCE BY (SULLIVAN) _____ EVIDENCE _____ PIED OBJECTS _____ MEASUREMENTS _____ REMARKS _____
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[illegible]

- Prepares the evidence log
- Receives and records all evidence
- Coordinates evidence packaging and preservation
- Located outside of secure area



Evidence Custodian									
EVIDENCE RECOVERY LOG								PAGE	OF
LOCATION _____ DATE _____ CASE IDENTIFIER _____ PREPARER/ASSISTANTS _____								PERSONNEL _____ _____ _____ _____	
ITEM #	DESCRIPTION	WHERE FOUND	RECOVERED BY	PHOTO	MARKING (Drawn or Indiced) — 1	PACKAGING METHOD(S)	MISCELLANEOUS COMMENTS		
	What?	Where?	Who?	Y/N	D/I				
						Paper	Valuable		
						Plastic	Drug		
						Box	Firearm		
						Can	Bio-		
						Overpack	Hazard		
							HazMat		
							Explosive		
							Wet		

Evidence Recovery Personnel

- Locate and collect evidence
- Significant evidence is photographed before it is collected
- Initial and date all evidence and turn it over to the evidence custodian



Specialists



- The team leader will consider what specialists might be necessary to assist with processing the crime scene
- This is done during the preliminary survey

Specialists

Specialists include:

- Anthropologists
- Blood spatter experts
- Entomologists
- Botanists
- Geologists
- Fingerprint specialists
- Bomb technicians
- HAZMAT personnel
- Cadaver dogs
- Dive Team

12 Stages of Crime Scene Processing



12 Stages of a Crime Scene Search

- Preparation
- Approach scene
- Secure and protect scene
- Initiate preliminary survey
- Evaluate physical evidence possibilities
- Prepare narrative description
- Depict scene photographically
- Prepare diagram/sketch of scene
- Conduct detailed search
- Record & collect physical evidence
- Conduct final survey
- Release scene



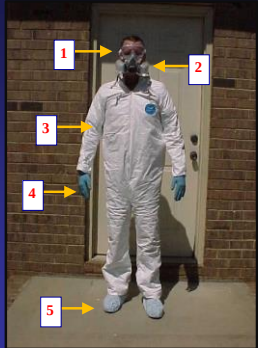
1. Preparation

- Team Leader Assigns Tasks
 - photographer, sketch artist, search personnel, etc.
- Acquire Equipment and Supplies
 - Paperwork, packaging materials, PPE
- Evaluate Legal Ramifications
 - Has a search warrant been obtained
- Consider comforts and safety of personnel
 - Food, water, shifts, shelter
- Determine Need for Specialized Assistance
 - Bomb Techs, HAZMAT, CART, Cadaver Dogs, Dive Team



Crime Scene Hazards

1. **Goggles/eye protection** - splash and mucous membrane tissue protection.
2. **Face/particle mask** - inhalation protection.
3. **Tyvek suit** - impervious to liquid contaminants.
4. **Rubber gloves** - impervious to liquid contaminants.
5. **Booties** - splash and contact protection for footwear.



2. Approach Scene

- Careful approach
 - Avoid destroying evidence
 - Be aware of transient evidence: shoe and tire impressions, hairs, fibers
- Make pertinent notes concerning observations
- Take control of the scene from first responders
- Consider personnel safety
- Establish Perimeter
 - Outdoor: larger perimeter
 - Indoor: more self contained



3. Secure and Protect the Scene



The crime scene perimeter is established 1.5 times the distance from the center of the scene to the furthest known piece of evidence identified (in all directions).

3. Secure and Protect Scene

- Take control upon arrival
- Determine extent of scene protection
- Check for adequate scene security
- Obtain information regarding the original condition of the crime scene
- Take extensive notes - do not rely on memory
- Keep out unauthorized personnel
- Record who enters and leaves scene
- Protect outdoor locations from weather

4. Initiate Preliminary Survey

- Conducted by Team Leader and Photographer
- Initial cautious walk through of the scene
- Identify the extent of the search area - may require expanding initial perimeter
- Consider the methods and procedures needed to process the scene
- Determine additional manpower, equipment and specialist needs
- Adjust personnel assignments if necessary
- Identify and protect transient evidence
- Make extensive notes to document physical and environmental conditions

5. Evaluate Physical Evidence

- Evaluation begins upon arrival at the scene
- Becomes more detailed in preliminary survey stage
- Concentrate on the most transient evidence first and work towards least transient
- Ensure you have appropriate packaging material for evidence to be collected



6. Narrative Description

- Narrative is a running general description of the condition of the crime scene
- Present an overall general to specific description of crime scene
- Note items that catch your attention
- Methods of narrative can be:

Audio

Written

Video
